Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 12

Grassroots Democracy – Part 3: Local Government in Urban Areas

इस अध्याय में शहरों और कस्बों में स्थानीय शासन, नगर निगम, नगरपालिका, नगर पंचायत, वार्ड समितियों और नागरिकों की जिम्मेदारियों के बारे में बताया गया है। नीचे पाठ के प्रश्नों और गतिविधियों के उत्तर Simple English में दिए गए हैं। इसके बाद सभी प्रमुख टॉपिक्स से महत्वपूर्ण संभावित प्रश्न-उत्तर, परिभाषाएँ, MCQs और True/False भी दिए गए हैं।

1. The Big Questions – Answers

Q1. What are urban local bodies and what are their functions?

Answer: Urban local bodies are local government institutions that work in cities and towns. They provide basic services such as water supply, sanitation, garbage collection, road maintenance, streetlights and public health services. They also collect certain local taxes and help in the development of urban areas.

Q2. Why are urban local bodies important in governance and democracy?

Answer: Urban local bodies are important because they bring government closer to the people. Citizens elect their representatives and can raise local problems. These bodies help people participate in decision-making and improve their neighbourhoods.

2. Textbook Questions and Activities – Answers

Q1. Why is a city like Kolkata, Chennai or Mumbai more complex and diverse than a village or a town?

Answer: A large city has a very large population. People from different regions, languages, religions and cultures live there. Cities also have more traffic, buildings, businesses, industries and public services. Therefore, their problems and administration are more complex than those of a village.

Q2. Make a list of diverse communities living in a city. What do you observe?

Answer: A city may have people from different states, religions, languages and cultural backgrounds. For example, people may speak Hindi, Bengali, Tamil, Marathi, Urdu and other languages.

Observation: People have different customs, food habits and festivals, but they live and work together in the same city.

Q3. What similarities and differences do you notice between Panchayati Raj and urban local government?

Answer:

Similarities:

- Both are systems of local self-government.
- Both have elected representatives.
- Both provide services and work for local development.
- Both allow citizens to raise local problems.

Differences:

- Panchayati Raj works in rural areas.
- Urban local bodies work in cities and towns.
- Rural governance includes Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti and Zila Parishad.
- Urban governance includes Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council and Municipal Corporation, depending on the size and status of the settlement.

Q4. Can you think of four or five actions responsible citizens can take to help their city?

Answer:

1. Put waste in the correct dustbins.
2. Separate wet and dry waste.
3. Report leaking water pipes and blocked drains.
4. Keep public places clean.
5. Save water and electricity.
6. Follow traffic rules and protect public property.

Q5. What could have been the role of Indore's citizens in making it a clean city?

Answer: Citizens may have helped by keeping streets clean, separating waste, using dustbins, avoiding littering, cooperating with waste collectors and spreading awareness about cleanliness. The cooperation of citizens and the municipal authorities is important for keeping a city clean.

Q6. How can we find out whether a city has a Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council or Municipal Corporation?

Answer: We can check the official website of the local urban body or the State Urban Development Department. We can also ask local government officials or consult official municipal records.

Q7. How do urban local bodies fund their activities? Are some services paid services?

Answer: Urban local bodies get money from local taxes, fees, fines, service charges and government grants.

Examples of paid services may include water tanker services, certain licences, auditorium bookings and some waste-removal services. Basic services and charges vary from one local body to another.

Q8. On your way to school, you notice that a water pipe is leaking. What would you and your friends do?

Answer: We would inform our teacher, parents or a responsible adult and report the leakage to the municipal office or the relevant water-supply authority. We would give the exact location of the leak. We would not try to repair the pipe ourselves. Reporting the problem quickly can save water.

Q9. Prepare questions to ask a member of an urban local body.

Answer: We can ask the following questions:

1. What are your main duties?
2. How are local problems reported and solved?
3. How does the urban local body collect funds?
4. What steps are taken to keep the city clean?
5. How are roads, drains and streetlights maintained?
6. How can citizens participate in local development?
7. What action is taken when water is wasted or drains are blocked?
8. How does the local body help during floods or other emergencies?

Q10. Discuss with family and neighbours their expectations from urban local bodies.

Answer: People may expect the urban local body to provide clean drinking water, good roads, working streetlights, proper drainage, regular garbage collection, clean public toilets, public health services, safe public spaces and quick action on complaints.

Q11. Make a list of the characteristics of a good urban local body.

Answer: A good urban local body should be honest, transparent, responsible, efficient and responsive to citizens. It should use public funds properly, provide essential services fairly, listen to complaints and involve people in local decisions.

3. Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic A: Urban Local Government

Q1. What is urban local government?

Answer: Urban local government is a system through which cities and towns manage local services and solve local problems.

Q2. What are urban local bodies?

Answer: Urban local bodies are local government institutions that manage the needs of cities and towns.

Q3. What is meant by decentralisation?

Answer: Decentralisation means sharing powers and responsibilities with local levels of government instead of keeping all decisions with one central authority.

Q4. Why is urban local government necessary?

Answer: Urban local government is necessary to manage roads, water supply, drainage, waste collection, streetlights, public health and other local services.

Q5. What is participatory democracy?

Answer: Participatory democracy is a system in which people take an active part in public affairs and decision-making.

Q6. How can citizens participate in urban governance?

Answer: Citizens can elect representatives, attend local meetings where available, report problems, submit complaints, give suggestions and cooperate with local authorities.

Topic B: Types of Urban Local Bodies

Q7. Name the main types of urban local bodies mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: The main types are:

1. Nagar Panchayat.

2. Municipal Council.
3. Municipal Corporation.

Q8. What is a Nagar Panchayat?

Answer: A Nagar Panchayat is an urban local body for a smaller town or an area changing from rural to urban.

Q9. What is a Municipal Council?

Answer: A Municipal Council, also called a Nagar Palika, is an urban local body for a town or city of moderate size.

Q10. What is a Municipal Corporation?

Answer: A Municipal Corporation, also called a Mahanagar Nigam, is an urban local body for a large city.

Q11. According to the chapter, which local body generally serves a city with a population above 10 lakh?

Answer: According to the chapter, a Municipal Corporation is the highest urban local body in a city with a population above 10 lakh.

Q12. Which body generally serves a town or city with a population between 1 lakh and 10 lakh?

Answer: According to the chapter's simplified description, a Municipal Council serves such a town or city.

Q13. Which body serves smaller towns?

Answer: A Nagar Panchayat serves smaller towns or areas that are changing from rural to urban. The exact classification depends on the relevant State law.

Topic C: Wards and Ward Committees

Q14. What is a ward?

Answer: A ward is a smaller area into which a city or town is divided for local administration and representation.

Q15. What is a Ward Committee?

Answer: A Ward Committee is a local body or committee that helps address issues affecting a ward. Its exact structure and responsibilities differ from State to State.

Q16. What are the functions of Ward Committees?

Answer: Ward Committees may help organise health camps, promote cleanliness, raise awareness against single-use plastics and report problems such as leaking pipes, blocked drains and damaged roads.

Q17. Why are wards important in a large city?

Answer: Wards divide a large city into smaller areas. This makes it easier to identify local problems and represent the needs of residents.

Q18. How can people raise a problem in their ward?

Answer: They can contact their elected ward representative, the municipal office or the relevant complaint service. They should provide the location and details of the problem.

Topic D: Functions of Urban Local Bodies

Q19. What are the main functions of urban local bodies?

Answer: Their main functions include:

- Maintaining local roads and streetlights.
- Providing or managing water-supply services.
- Collecting and disposing of garbage.
- Maintaining drains and sanitation.
- Supporting public health and cleanliness.
- Maintaining certain public places and burial grounds.
- Collecting local taxes, fees and fines.
- Helping implement government schemes.
- Planning local economic and social development.

Q20. Why is garbage segregation important?

Answer: Garbage segregation means separating waste into different categories, such as wet and dry waste. It makes collection and recycling easier and helps keep the city clean.

Q21. Why should water leakage be reported quickly?

Answer: Water leakage wastes precious water. Quick reporting helps the authorities repair the pipe and prevent further wastage.

Q22. What role do urban local bodies play in public health?

Answer: They help maintain sanitation, manage waste, keep public areas clean and support public health services within their responsibilities.

Q23. How can urban local bodies help during emergencies?

Answer: They can help coordinate local services, provide information, clear affected areas and work with health, fire, police and disaster-management authorities.

Topic E: Taxes, Fees and Services

Q24. How do urban local bodies get money?

Answer: They get money from local taxes, fees, fines, service charges and grants from the government.

Q25. What is property tax?

Answer: Property tax is a tax charged on certain properties, such as houses or buildings, according to applicable local rules.

Q26. What are water charges?

Answer: Water charges are fees paid for water services where such charges apply.

Q27. What is a trade licence?

Answer: A trade licence is official permission required for certain businesses under local rules.

Q28. Why do urban local bodies collect taxes and fees?

Answer: They collect taxes and fees to help pay for public services and local development work.

Q29. Are all municipal services free?

Answer: No. Some services may be free or funded from public revenue, while others may require a fee or service charge. The rules differ between local bodies.

Topic F: Citizens' Duties and Community Participation

Q30. Why do citizens have duties towards their city?

Answer: Citizens use public services and shared spaces. Their cooperation helps the local body work efficiently and keeps the city clean, safe and healthy.

Q31. How can citizens help in waste management?

Answer: They can separate wet and dry waste, use dustbins, avoid littering and follow the local waste-collection rules.

Q32. How can citizens protect public property?

Answer: They should not damage roads, benches, streetlights, parks, buses or other public facilities. They should report damage to the authorities.

Q33. What can citizens do if a drain is blocked?

Answer: They should report it to the municipal office or ward representative and provide the location. They should not enter the drain or attempt dangerous repairs.

Q34. Why is cooperation between citizens and local government important?

Answer: Local government cannot solve every problem without public cooperation. Citizens' participation helps identify problems, use services properly and improve the neighbourhood.

Topic G: Important Historical Facts

Q35. Which is the oldest municipal institution in India mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The Madras Corporation, now called the Greater Chennai Corporation, is described in the chapter as the oldest municipal institution in India.

Q36. When was the Madras Corporation established?

Answer: It was established on 29 September 1688.

Q37. When was the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai created, according to the chapter?

Answer: It was created in 1865. The chapter's photograph on page 173 identifies the institution and gives this historical date.

Q38. What is the importance of the Madras Corporation's history?

Answer: Its history shows that organised municipal administration has existed in India for a long time. The chapter also notes that a Parliamentary Act of 1792 gave the corporation power to levy municipal taxes.

Q39. What lesson does the example of Indore teach us?

Answer: The example of Indore shows that a clean city requires both effective municipal services and responsible citizens. Waste segregation, proper disposal and public cooperation are important for cleanliness.

4. Important Terms and Definitions

Term	Simple meaning
Urban Local Government	Local government for cities and towns.
Urban Local Body	An institution that manages local services in an urban area.
Decentralisation	Sharing powers and responsibilities with lower levels of government.
Participatory Democracy	A system in which people take part in public decisions.
Nagar Panchayat	Local government for a smaller town or an area changing from rural to urban.
Municipal Council	Local government for a town or medium-sized urban area.
Municipal Corporation	Local government for a large city.
Mahanagar Nigam	Another name for a Municipal Corporation.
Nagar Palika	Another name for a Municipal Council.
Ward	A smaller administrative area within a city or town.
Ward Committee	A committee that helps address issues affecting a ward.
Property Tax	A tax charged on property according to local rules.
Water Charges	Fees charged for water services where applicable.
Trade Licence	Official permission required for certain businesses.
Waste Segregation	Separating waste into different categories.
Public Property	Property and facilities meant for public use.
Local Tax	A tax collected by a local authority under applicable rules.
Citizen Participation	People's involvement in local decision-making and community work.

5. Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

Practice Test

0 / 15 answered

1. Urban local bodies mainly work in:

A. Forests only
B. Cities and towns
C. Only villages
D. Only the national capital

2. Which is an example of an urban local body?

A. Gram Sabha
B. Zila Parishad
C. Municipal Corporation

D. Panchayat Samiti

3. A Municipal Corporation generally serves:

A. A large city
B. Only a village
C. A single farm
D. A small school

4. A smaller area within a city is called a:

A. District
B. Ward
C. State
D. Block

5. What does decentralisation mean?

A. Keeping all power in one office
B. Sharing power and responsibilities with local levels
C. Stopping public services
D. Removing elected representatives

6. Which body may help report a blocked drain in a ward?

A. Ward Committee
B. Parliament only
C. A school class only
D. A village Gram Sabha in every case

7. Which of these is a function of an urban local body?

A. Managing local waste collection
B. Printing all national currency
C. Defending the country's borders
D. Making foreign policy

8. What is waste segregation?

A. Burning all waste together
B. Separating waste into categories
C. Throwing waste into a river
D. Leaving waste on the road

9. Which of these can be a source of municipal income?

A. Local taxes and fees
B. Only donations from children
C. Only foreign currency
D. No source of income

10. Which city is associated with the oldest municipal institution mentioned in the chapter?

A. Jaipur
B. Chennai
C. Patna
D. Bhopal

11. When was the Madras Corporation established?

A. 1688
B. 1792
C. 1865
D. 1947

12. The Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai was created in:

A. 1688
B. 1757
C. 1865
D. 1950

13. What should students do when they notice a leaking water pipe?

A. Try to repair it themselves
B. Ignore it
C. Report it to a responsible adult or the relevant authority
D. Break the pipe

14. Which action helps keep a city clean?

A. Littering in public places
B. Separating waste and using dustbins
C. Blocking drains
D. Wasting water

15. Why are urban local bodies important?

A. They manage local services and address local problems
B. They replace all courts
C. They control every country
D. They make all international laws

Check Answers

6. True or False

1. Urban local bodies work in cities and towns. — True
2. Panchayati Raj institutions mainly serve rural areas. — True
3. A ward is a smaller area within a city or town. — True
4. A Municipal Corporation generally serves a large city. — True
5. Urban local bodies have no role in garbage collection. — False
6. Citizens should report leaking water pipes. — True
7. All municipal services are always free. — False
8. Waste segregation can help improve waste management. — True
9. The Madras Corporation was established in 1688. — True
10. The Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai was created in 1865, according to the chapter. — True
11. Citizens have no duties towards their neighbourhood. — False
12. Urban local bodies may collect local taxes and fees. — True
13. Ward arrangements are exactly the same in every State. — False
14. Citizens and local authorities should work together to keep cities clean. — True
15. Participatory democracy encourages people to take part in public affairs. — True

7. Short-Answer Questions for Exam Practice

Q1. Name the three main types of urban local bodies.

Answer: Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council and Municipal Corporation.

Q2. What is the main difference between rural and urban local government?

Answer: Rural local government works in villages, while urban local government works in towns and cities.

Q3. Name any four functions of urban local bodies.

Answer: Water supply, garbage collection, road maintenance and sanitation.

Q4. Name any four sources of income for urban local bodies.

Answer: Local taxes, fees, fines and government grants.

Q5. Why should citizens report local problems?

Answer: Reporting problems helps authorities take timely action and prevents further damage or waste.

Q6. What are two responsibilities of a good citizen?

Answer: A good citizen should keep public places clean and protect public property.

Q7. What is the difference between a Municipal Council and a Municipal Corporation?

Answer: A Municipal Council generally serves a smaller urban area, while a Municipal Corporation generally serves a larger city.

Q8. Why is citizen participation important in urban governance?

Answer: It helps identify local problems, improve services and make local authorities more accountable.

8. Quick Revision Notes

- Urban local bodies manage local services in cities and towns.
- Decentralisation means sharing powers and responsibilities with local government.
- Participatory democracy encourages people to take part in decisions.
- Nagar Panchayat serves a smaller town or an area changing from rural to urban.
- Municipal Council generally serves a town or medium-sized urban area.
- Municipal Corporation generally serves a large city.
- Ward is a smaller area within a city.
- Ward Committees help raise and address local issues.
- Urban local bodies manage services such as roads, water, sanitation, garbage collection and local public facilities.
- Their funds may come from taxes, fees, fines, service charges and government grants.
- Citizens should save water, segregate waste, protect public property and report local problems.
- The Madras Corporation was established on 29 September 1688, according to the chapter.
- The Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai was created in 1865, according to the chapter.

Exam preparation tip: Give special attention to the three types of urban local bodies, their functions, the meaning of wards and decentralisation, sources of municipal income, citizens' duties, and the comparison between rural and urban local government.